

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Counter-Strike

Counter Strike (CS) started off as a mod for *Half-Life* in 1999. Close to a decade later, it is still one of the most-played games on and off the Internet, although it's a pretty repetitive game. Now you'll see people on LANs using terms and abbreviations like...

Steam: The network that is used to distribute, authenticate, and keep track of games and game servers.

Maps: *Counter-Strike* maps usually start with the tags `de_`, `cs_`, and `as_`. `de_` denotes bomb-defusing maps, `cs_` are hostage-rescuing maps, and `as_` are assassinations maps. Some of the famous maps in CS are `de_dust`, `de_aztec`, and `de_inferno`... called *dust*, *tec* and *ferno* by regulars.

Headshot: Headshot or HS's as they are called are single-shot kills (by shooting in the head)

Lag!: Used to describe game delay and disruption in multiplayer gameplay due to faulty or slow network connections.

Terrorists and Counter-Terrorists: The two teams in *Counter-Strike*, known as T's and CT's. Every map has a fixed spawn area for each team.

Owned — Owned or OWN3D or owned or PWNED are used to describe complete domination over the opponent in *Counter-Strike* and pretty much every other game.

Usage: Hey!! *Steam* isn't connecting?? Is it down?... I so badly want to play *as d2*. I hope I don't *lag* like last night. I'm going to join T's, it's more fun in *d2*. I intend on getting some really good HS's on the CT's. I hope they're prepared to get PWNED!

Wild Wild Web

Anti-Anti

There exist good people in the world. Some of these good people have, out of concern for the Internet community, joined the fight against all bytes evil—think phishing, malware and all. They set up sites for “anti” downloads. They give out newsletters on how to safeguard yourself against upcoming threats—in short, they give you the armour. In dishing out Goodware, they've attracted attention from the bad sort—the sort that actually spreads the aforementioned evil bytes.

So the Bad are now focusing attention on those

sites: “So *here's* where those dumbhead users get wise.” And they've taken to the stinkiest tactics possible—targeting the sites with distributed denial-of-service attacks and such. The securers of security are scrambling to get back online, and they're bold in their reaffirmations.

Visit CastleCops.com, for one. It's War!

E-commerce: The Cutting Edge

Unhappily-married folks of the type who engage in {ahem} extra-curricular activities will no longer have to stammer (or shout back, if

aggressive) when the suspicious spouse asks where he or she was Friday evening. Help is at hand for these harassed souls in the shape of Ibila.com, which is in the well-thought-out business of cooking up alibis to cover suspicious absences. A simple enough *modus operandi*: they'll call frantically from your workplace, send you invites to seminars... you can figure. And if the spouse is still sceptical about that convention, you also get handouts like pens and notebooks. Brilliant. No comment, except for this old one: What the Web hath Wrought!

starts off with unprintable characters, but Google helpfully translates them to “Thanks to the development of the world computer industry...”

Now the crazy whatnots at ICANN, apparently influenced by capitalists, are set to snuff out this last bastion of Godlessness. They are out to wipe .su off the Internet map. Why?

The reason being given is that of keeping up with the times, though the people behind the (thousands of, we hear) .su sites say it reminds them of the days when Sputnik orbited the earth and when wars were fought with ice, not shock or awe.

They also point out that decadent imperialists are following double standards by using the semi-formal .uk domain instead of .gb (ha-ha! Bet you didn't know!). The world at large has been assured that there are no fears of a Cold War breaking out on the Internet, but we have our doubts: nostalgia is one thing, but never, we say, underestimate the power of a country that sent Man and Woman and Dog into space while Americans were waxing fat on burgers and Budweiser.

PURR TALK

What's In A Meow?

Picture this—you have a cat (though God only knows why you have one of those instead of a Best Friend of Man), and the vaguely snake-like creature is all over you, purring and meowing and rubbing herself against your legs when you unlock your door. Or maybe you heard a snarl-like eruption from the pussycat you're so lovingly fondling.

For baffled owners who wonder what those purrs and growls mean, help is at hand. All it takes is a transfer of \$75 to Takara Tomy for the Meowlingual. And oh, you will need to take Japanese classes. (But Japanese is a whole lot easier to learn than Cat.)

The Meowlingual is a brightly-coloured plastic device that looks like a slim tiffin box, and it has a dial. No complex configuration—just switch it on and place it next to the tabby that's doing God knows what

kind of body movement and making silly, incoherent sounds. Wait for a moment, and the Meowlingual will play an audio clip in Japanese. Now, if you *did* learn Japanese, you'd catch something like “Stop petting me so much, moron,” or, more likely, “Kill Fido or I'll run away—and I *know* you love me, even if I don't reciprocate.” And you and your cat would live happily ever after. Or, perhaps, part ways—hopefully not in the distasteful (a pun here!) manner of she being sold to the seedy-Chinese-restaurant owner.

Now, not to degrade or disrespect women, we'd love to know what they,

